

Conclusion and Governance in Practice

WHY THIS MODULE MATTERS

Knowledge without application is not governance. This closing module brings every framework in the course together and sets you up for the Final Certification Exam.

10.1 Bringing the Course Together

This course opened by separating AI ethics — the standard for what a system should do — from AI governance, the organisational machinery that makes meeting that standard consistent. Module 2 examined generative design and the line between inspiration and reproduction through the Shein litigation. Module 3 used the Levi's and Vogue/Guess controversies to show how framing and disclosure failures damage brands. Module 4 set out how retail AI fails technically, socially and organisationally. Module 5 grounded everything in UK GDPR. Modules 6 to 9 applied all of it to marketing, buying, recruitment and sustainability claims in turn.

10.2 Governance Structures That Fit Fashion Businesses

Fashion and retail organisations rarely have a dedicated AI governance function, and do not need one to govern AI well. What they need is clear ownership attached to existing roles, and a review route proportionate to risk.

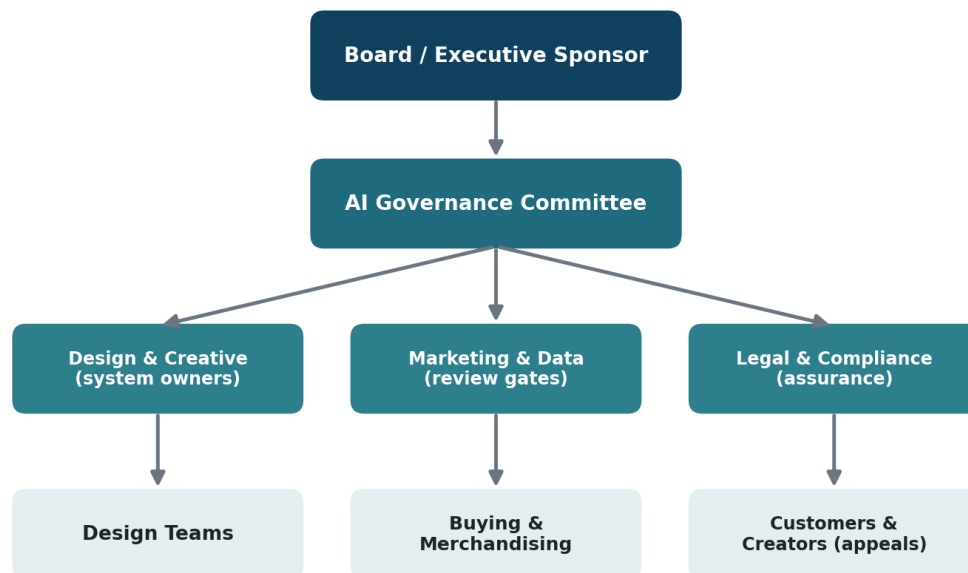


Figure 10.1 — A governance structure mapped onto roles a fashion business already has.

- **AI inventory** — a maintained list of every AI system in use, its purpose, owner and risk tier. Most businesses discover they are running more AI tools than anyone had counted.
- **Named accountability** — each system has one named owner, not a committee and not a department.

- Risk-tiered review** — depth of scrutiny scales with impact on individuals, as set out in Module 4.
- Escalation without penalty** — a designer, buyer or recruiter who flags a concern should be treated as doing their job, not obstructing a launch.
- Monitoring after launch** — with a named recipient for every dashboard, since an unread dashboard is not monitoring.

10.3 Assessing Where You Are Now

Organisations rarely move from no governance to full governance in one step. Locating yourself honestly on a maturity scale is more useful than aspiring to the top of it immediately.

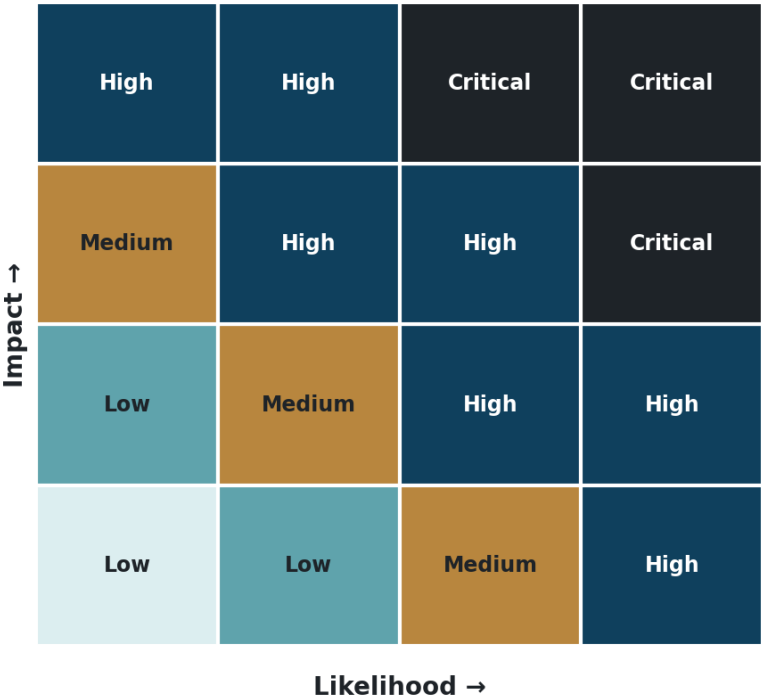


Figure 10.2 — Prioritising review effort by likelihood and impact.

10.4 Capstone Exercise

To complete certification, apply this course's frameworks to a real or hypothetical AI system used in your own organisation. At minimum, identify: what the system does and who it affects; its risk tier; its named

accountable owner; its lawful basis for processing personal data and whether a DPIA is required; which of the three failure categories it is most exposed to; the monitoring metric that would reveal a problem; and the route by which a customer, candidate or member of staff could challenge an outcome.

TRY THIS — THE CAPSTONE, IN ONE PAGE

Write one paragraph against each of the seven points in section 10.4 for a system your organisation actually runs — a recommendation engine, a screening tool, a forecasting model, a generative design tool. If you cannot complete all seven, that gap is itself the most useful finding this course can give you, and the right place to start.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Ethics defines the standard; governance is what makes meeting it consistent rather than dependent on who happens to be in the room.
- Fashion businesses do not need a dedicated AI function — they need named ownership attached to existing roles and review proportionate to risk.
- Most organisations are running more AI tools than anyone has counted; an inventory is almost always the highest-value first step.
- The recurring question across every module is the same: who could this affect, how would we know if it caused harm, and who is accountable for finding out.
- Certification is a starting point for continued practice, not an end state.

FURTHER READING

- ICO — Accountability Framework, ico.org.uk
- NIST — AI Risk Management Framework 1.0, nist.gov
- ISO/IEC 42001:2023 — AI management system standard, iso.org

MODULE 10 CHECK-IN QUIZ

Five questions to confirm your understanding before moving on. Answers are provided in the Answer Key at the end of the course.

1. What distinguishes AI ethics from AI governance in this course?

- A. They are the same thing
- B. Governance applies only to regulated sectors
- C. Ethics defines the standard; governance makes meeting it consistent rather than dependent on who is in the room
- D. Ethics applies only to creative teams

2. What does Module 10 identify as usually the highest-value first governance step?

- A. Hiring a dedicated AI ethics officer
- B. Purchasing an AI governance platform
- C. Publishing an AI ethics statement
- D. Building an AI inventory, since most organisations run more AI tools than anyone has counted

3. What does “named accountability” mean in practice?

- A. Each system has one named owner, not a committee or a department
- B. A committee is responsible for all AI systems
- C. The board is responsible for every system
- D. The vendor is responsible

4. What is the recurring question across every module of this course?

- A. How much will this system cost?
- B. Who could this affect, how would we know if it caused harm, and who is accountable for finding out?
- C. Which vendor has the best technology?
- D. How fast can this be deployed?

5. What does the capstone exercise require learners to identify?

- A. Only the system's technical architecture
- B. Only the system's annual licence cost
- C. What the system does and who it affects, its risk tier, named owner, lawful basis and DPIA status, failure exposure, monitoring metric, and challenge route
- D. Only whether the system uses machine learning